



Taki Academy

English

Level: 3rd form

Lessons: Module 6 – Part 3

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73.832.000

Text

1. The death toll from devastating floods in and around the South African port city of Durban has risen to 306. The heaviest rains in 60 years pummelled Durban's municipality, eThekweni in Zulu. According to an AFP tally, the storm is the deadliest on record in South Africa. Days of driving rain flooded several areas, smashed houses and ravaged infrastructure across the city, while landslides forced train services to be suspended across the province. The rains flooded highways to such depths that only the tops of traffic lights poked out. Southern parts of the country are bearing the brunt of the climate crisis.

2. The South African president, Cyril Ramaphosa, has described the floods as a "catastrophe" and a "calamity". "Bridges have collapsed. Roads have collapsed. People have died ... This is a catastrophe of enormous proportions," he said, addressing a local community after inspecting the damage from the floods. The national police force deployed 300 extra officers to the region, as the air force sent planes to help with the rescue operations. Torrents tore several bridges apart, submerged cars and collapsed houses. A fuel tanker floated at sea after being swept off the road. More than 6,000 homes were damaged. After TV footage showed people stealing from shipping containers during the flooding, the provincial government condemned the reported looting.

3. South Africa's neighbours like Mozambique and Zimbabwe suffer such natural disasters from tropical storms almost every year, but Africa's most industrialised country is largely shielded from the storms that form over the Indian Ocean. President Cyril Ramaphosa blames 'catastrophic' rainfall in KwaZulu-Natal on climate crisis. "This disaster is part of climate change. We no longer can postpone what we need to do ... to deal with climate change. It is here, and our disaster management capability needs to be at a higher level." These rains were not tropical, but rather caused by a weather system called a cutoff low that had brought rain and cold weather to much of the country. When storms reached the warmer and more humid climate in Durban's KZN province, even more rain poured down.

The Guardian April 2022 (adapted)

A- Comprehension Questions

1- Tick the most appropriate title for the text:

- a- The Impact of Tropical Storms on Durban
- b- Emergency Response to Looting in Durban
- c- Lethal Floods in Durban Linked to Climate Crisis

☐
☐
☒

2- Complete the table with information from paragraph 2:

Natural Disaster	Setting	Casualties
Floods	Durban, South Africa	306

3- For each of the following statements, pick one detail from the text showing that it is

false:

- a- The implications of the disaster do not seem threatening. (paragraph 1)

The storm is the deadliest on record.

- b- The natural disaster hits the devastated country annually. (paragraph 3)

Africa's most industrialized country is largely shielded from the storm.

- c- The government considers the catastrophe God-made. (paragraph 3)

blames rainfall on climate crisis.

4- Read paragraph 2 and answer the following question

What are the measures taken to save the environment?

- a- the national police force deployed 300 extra
b- the air force sent planes to help with the rescue operations.

5- Find words in the text meaning nearly the same as: (2 mark)

- a- Criticized (paragraph 2)= condemned
✓ / p.p.
b- Delay (paragraph 3)= postpone
✓

6- Give a personal justified answer to the following question: (1 mark)

Do you think climate change can be slowed down? Why? Why not?

Yes, I think climate change can be slowed down if both individuals and governments take urgent action by reducing pollution and using renewable energy.

B- Language:

1- Put the words between brackets in the right tense or form:

In the space of 16 months, Sandra went from attending her daughter's wedding to being chief mourner at her funeral. Her daughter Emily (just / begin) had just begun her honeymoon at a beachside hotel in Thailand when a (death) deadly tsunami struck. What was meant to be a romantic boat trip turned into a nightmare as giant waves (smash) smashed boats and swept away everything in their path. Emily's husband survived the disaster, but Emily was listed among the casualties.

The devastation **left** behind was unimaginable—corpses **lined** the shore, hotels **were** reduced to rubble, and the damage was **beyond** ^{N (believe)} **belief**. Sandra **flew out** on the next available flight, clinging to hope, only to be shown Emily's wedding ring found near the wreckage. Amid the loss of life, Sandra **(tearful)** ^{tearfully} **clutched** the wedding pictures at the funeral, **(mourn)** ^{mourning} not just the loss of a daughter but of a future stolen by the sea.

2- Fill in the blanks with 6 words from the box: (3 marks)

costly – highlights – causing – those – induced – significantly – compelling – disruptive

A recent study by the Scripps Institute of Oceanography provides strong evidence that global warming is driven by human activity rather than natural causes. Researchers found clear signs of human—**induced** warming in the oceans, which is expected to **significantly** affect global water resources. This research **reduces** uncertainty in climate change debates and **highlights** the urgency of the issue. However, some **world** **leaders**, including **those** in the U.S., continue to dismiss these findings to avoid **costly** **environmental** **regulations**, which is one reason the U.S. has not signed the Kyoto Protocol. Professor Tim Barnett called the study the **most** **compelling** **evidence** yet, warning that melting glaciers could soon disrupt water supplies for millions in regions like the Andes and western China.

proof (v: to prove)

3- Put the bracketed words in the right tense/form:

Our knowledge of past and future extinction rates shows that the problem of extinction is both serious and urgent. Although the number of extinct species does not yet represent a large proportion of all species, it **[is (ecological)]** *ecologically* **ADV** important. **[Adj]** In fact, if current trends continue, a large fraction of the world's species could soon be **(go)** *gone* **(weak)** *extinct* **Sbj = it** ecosystems. Each species **(S. present)** plays a specific role in its environment, and losing one can have **(not/ expected)** *unexpected* **Adj** consequences on others. In addition, human activities such as deforestation, pollution, and climate **N** change are accelerating this crisis. **If** no action **(take)** *was taken* **S. past**, the damage **could become** irreversible. Therefore, it is essential to raise **(aware)** *awareness* **Noun**, protect endangered species, and adopt more sustainable ways of living. *↳ what?*

C- Writing:

→ Reporting an Event

1- Guided Writing: Use the notes below to write a paragraph about Land Day:

Celebration	March 30, annual
Launching date	1976
Activity	Plant olive trees
Aims	- assert Palestinians' commitment to their land - commemorate the lives lost in the events of 1976

Foundation → was founded

Celebration → is celebrated *//annually/ yearly*

Activity → On this day, people (celebrate by...)

Aims / Purpose / Mission → Its main

purpose is to + v(inf) // It also aims at + v(+ing)

Land Day is celebrated annually on March 30. It was launched in 1976. On this day, people plant olive trees. The main purpose behind Land Day is to assert Palestinians'

2- Essay:

"All we require is the ^{determination} will. The next few decades represent a final opportunity to build a stable home for ourselves and restore the rich, healthy and wonderful world that we inherited from Planet earth our distant ^{ancestors} ancestors. Our future on the planet, the only place as far as we know where life of any kind exists, is ^{forefathers} at stake." — David Attenborough.

Write an ^{in danger / at risk} article in which you react to this quote, offering ways to save planet earth from the imminent dangers of global warming.

Global Warming: Is it too late?

Our planet is facing unprecedented environmental crises. According to David Attenborough, humanity is running out of time. Unless we act soon, our life on earth is "at stake". Here are some ways we can save planet earth.

Body=

1. transitioning to clean energy

Sources=

from fossil fuels (coal - oil - gas)

to renewable energy sources (wind-
hydro- solar)
→ to create a cleaner future

2. Reforestation=

- planting trees
- enforcing stricter laws against deforestation

→ to maintain ecological balance as forests are the lungs of the planet

3. Adopting eco- friendly practices=

- opting for the 3 Rs (Reduce- Reuse- Recycle)
- using less plastic
- using ecofriendly household appliances
- lowering energy consumption
- green transportation

Conclusion-

In short, the future of our planet lies in our hands. Climate is a real threat, but we can slow it down through collective effort. It's high time we did something as there is no planet B.